

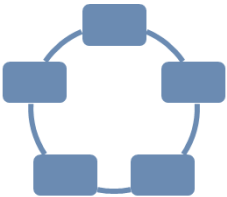
Communicating Qualitative Insights

Created by Courtney Pierson, Matt Kummell & Amy Florentino
Tuck School of Business at Dartmouth

CHART TYPE	OVERVIEW	TIPS AND CONSIDERATIONS
Flow Diagrams		
Chevrons 	• Used to show sequence of steps or stages of a process in a compact form • Consists of stacked layers or arrows	• Use to clearly visualize steps • Arrows can vary in size for emphasis • Best for linear processes • Useful for project timelines or value chain analysis • May oversimplify complex processes
Funnels 	• Used to depict stages of a process where data is filtered progressively • Shaped like a funnel, showing reduction at each stage	• Highlights stages and filtering • Easily identifies trends over time • Ideal for processes with clear filtering progression (e.g., sales process from lead generation to completed sale)
Cycle Diagrams 	• Illustrates recurring processes or sequences. • Depicted as a circle divided into segments.	• Clear representation of cycles • Can be used for a linear process with an iterative element (right diagram) • Ideal for cyclical processes that loop back (e.g., feedback loops or continuous improvement cycles)

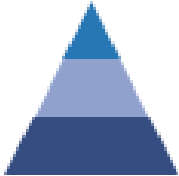
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Segments and Interrelation		
Segments 	- Divides information into segments or section, often circular - Each segment represents a different category, theme or variable	- Group similar elements for clarity - Useful for segmenting markets or customers
Venn Diagram 	- Illustrates relationships between different sets or groups - Overlapping circles show logical relations	- Simple and clear visualization of overlaps - Useful for comparing and contrasting products, services, processes, customer preferences, or anything that can be depicted in sets - Limit to a few data sets to avoid confusion
Stacked Venn 	- Variation of Venn diagram with overlapping areas stacked - Indicates relationships between multiple categories or criteria	- Useful for illustrating growth or gradation of an organization or business - Similar to a Venn diagram, limit to a few data sets

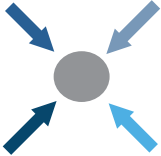
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Hierarchy		
Pyramid 	• Represents information in a hierarchical format • Largest section is at the base, smallest at the top.	• Useful for representing steps that have been taken toward a task • In addition to hierarchy, can also represent proportion, quantity or size including market shares, sales, investment quantities, or other figure-based data • Limited to hierarchical data that can be ordered progressively
Target / Bullseye 	• Prioritizes elements by importance or relevance • A conceptual diagram that represents a target or dartboard with central and surrounding elements	• Clear prioritization; helps you focus on most critical elements • Useful for highlighting target market or brand positioning • Can become cluttered with too many elements
Organization Chart 	• Represents the structure of an organization • Shows hierarchy of authority and relationships between individuals or departments	• Can become complex for large organizations • May need frequent updates • May be too busy for clean representation on a slide deck

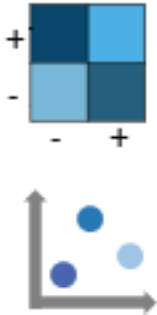
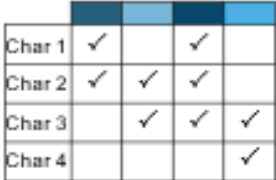
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Forces and Paths		
Force Field Analysis 	- Analyzes competing forces for and against change - Visualizes driving and restraining forces	- Useful for decision making and influencing change - Often used during analysis prior to a new product launch, a merger/acquisition or change management initiative - Can be subjective and oversimplify complex situations - Doesn't illustrate inter-dependencies between forces
Path Diagram 	- Illustrates alternative routes or options in a process - Highlights alternative options	- Shows how variable relationships - Probabilities can be added at each decision point - Can easily become too complex or too busy for slide deck presentation as paths are added - Useful to represent decision tree analysis or critical path analysis
Gantt Charts 	- Illustrates project schedules or timelines - Bar chart showing start and finish dates of project elements	- Used in project planning and scheduling - Highlights dependencies and critical path - Easy to track progress - Needs to be simplified if displaying on slide or sharing with client - Difficult to update unless using special software

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Comparisons		
Side-by-Side 	- Compares and contrasts qualitative data - Organizes data into clear categories	- Highlights differences between distinct elements or categories - Often designed as a T-chart (e.g., before and after; pros and cons) - Risk of slides becoming too wordy; beware of cognitive overload
Perceptual Maps 	- Structured framework to analyze and compare multiple variables or dimensions - Can be shown as a matrix diagram (discrete data) or continuous scale	- Allows for comprehensive analysis while remaining visually intuitive - Often shown as a 2x2 to display customer perception, brand positioning, or competitive landscape against two variables - Useful for complex comparisons including relative positioning between products, companies or brands - Highlights nuances and gradients when using continuous data
Table 	- Presents structured data in rows and columns - Organizes information clearly and neatly	- Easy to read and compare data - Various ways to quantify the comparison (e.g., simple checkmark to indicate inclusion, red/yellow/green scale to highlight sentiment or risk, Harvey balls to indicate degree each item meets a certain criteria) - Avoid making tables too text heavy